Introduction to linguistics II – Meaning and language use
Winter 2015/16 – Tuesday – 4:15 pm - 5:45 pm / Carl-Zeiss-Straße 3, SR 316

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Office Hours:
Wednesday, 12:00 – 13:00
or by appointment

Course site:
www.wordwise.uni-jena.de

Enrollment key: "MeanUse"
(without the quotes)

Course Description
This course is the second part of the introductory module in English linguistics. It will make students aware of the various functions of language in communication and of crucial aspects of the way in which meaning is communicated by means of language. Starting out from an introduction to basic aspects of communication in general, the seminar will cover major topics from semantics, concentrating on the meaning of morphemes, words and sentences, and various ways to investigate them. In order to understand how speakers communicate meanings/intentions in real contexts, the seminar will furthermore introduce the student to basic aspects of pragmatics and the study of language and thought.

Addressees: bachelor students of English, teacher students of English, students of business education

Course goals / What you will learn:
- You will become familiar with basic concepts of lexical and sentence meaning
- You will become familiar with approaches to utterance meaning and meaning and cognition
- You will acquire skills to analyze units of meaning and language use

Required Course Materials
You will find all readings online on our course website: http://www.wordwise.uni-jena.de/
The readings must be read **before** the relevant session. Optional texts repeat the contents of the obligatory texts in other words and/or provide you with additional insights. To pass the exam you do **not** need to read the optional readings.

Testing and Evaluation
The final grade is based on the written test. Moreover, as a weekly homework, I would like you to explain concisely and in your own words one of the concepts introduced in the text using an example not in the text. In order to be admitted to the exam, you will have to submit at least eight of these homework assignments in written form. Assignments only count as submitted if they are handed in on Monday **before** the relevant meeting.

Attendance Policy
Regular attendance is **not** mandatory. There is no need for medical certificates or e-mails.

Course outline

date	topic	**readings** [optional readings]
20.10.15	**Introduction**	
27.10.15	**Basics** semiotics, semantics, signs, significance, communication, semiotic triangle, lexemes, sense/reference/denotation, connotation, compositionality, idioms, levels of meaning	Riemer (2010), 1-6, 13-22
03.11.15	**word meaning I** categorization, classical categories, prototypes, componential analysis	Riemer (2010), 154-159, 224-233 [Givon 1986]
10.11.15	**word meaning II** meaning-to-form relations, lexicon, lexeme, ambiguity and disambiguation, polysemy, vagueness, metonymy, metaphor	Löbner (2013), chapter 3 [Pragglejaz Group 2007, 1-13] [Trueswell et al. 1994]
17.11.15	**word meaning III** meaning-to-meaning relations, synonymy, hyponymy, oppositions, lexical fields	Löbner (2013), chapter 8
24.11.15	**sentence meaning I** logical form, proposition, truth values, semantic presupposition, entailment	Riemer (2010), 173-186 Riemer (2010), 201-204, 215f.
01.12.15	**sentence meaning II** tense, aspect	Riemer (2010), 308-325 (not 9.2.2.1)
08.12.15	**sentence meaning III** thematic roles, argument structure	Riemer (2010), 335-352
15.12.15	**sentence meaning IV** constructions, compositionality, idioms	Goldberg (2003) Cruse (2004), chapter 4 (not 4.2)
05.01.16	**use and cognition I** communication, speech acts, implicatures	Akmajian et al. (1990), 307-315, 338-348 [Parker and Riley (2009)]
12.01.16	**use and cognition II** information structure, pragmatic presupposition, assertion	Lambrecht (1994), 36-56
19.01.16	**use and cognition III** identifiability, activation, reference, deixis	Cruse (2004), chaper 16 (not 16.2.4) [Lambrecht (1994), chapter 3]
26.01.16	**meaning, use and cognition I** word meaning: prototypes revisited, exemplars	Hampton (2016) [Geeraerts (2007)]
02.02.16	**meaning, use and cognition II** meaning and grammar: aspect revisited, linguistic relativism, thinking for speaking	Slobin (1991) [Carroll et al. (2004)]
09.02.16	questions, exercises, discussions, etc.	
16.02.16	**exam**	
22.03.16	**resit exam**	

Note: I reserve the right to alter this syllabus during the semester when I deem it necessary.

References

Akmajian, Adrian; Demers, Richard A.; Farmer, Ann K.; Harnish, Robert M. (1990): Linguistics, an introduction to language and communication. 3rd ed. Cambridge, Mass.: MIT Press.

Carroll, Mary; Stutterheim, Christiane von; Nuese, Ralf (2004): The language and thought debate: A psycholinguistic approach. In: Thomas Pechmann und Christopher Habel (Hg.): Multidisciplinary approaches to language production. Berlin, New York: Mounton de Gruyter, S. 183–218.

Cruse, Alan D. (2004): Meaning in Language: An Introduction to Semantics and Pragmatics. Oxford: Oxford University Press.

Geeraerts, Dirk (1988): Where Does Prototypicality Come From? In: Brygida Rudzka-Ostyn (Hg.): Topics in cognitive linguistics. Amsterdam, Philadelphia: J. Benjamins (Amsterdam studies in the theory and history of linguistic science. Series IV, Current issues in linguistic theory, 50), S. 207–229.

Givon, Talmy (1986): Prototypes: Between Plato and Wittgenstein. In: Colette Craig (Hg.): Noun Classes and Categorization. Amsterdam (Typological Studies in Language (TSLang): 7), S. 77.

Goldberg, Adele (2016): Compositionality. In: Nick Riemer (Hg.): The Routledge handbook of semantics. New York: Routledge (Routledge handbooks in linguistics).

Hampton, James A. (2016): Categories, Prototypes and Exemplars. In: Nick Riemer (Hg.): The Routledge handbook of semantics. New York: Routledge (Routledge handbooks in linguistics).

Lambrecht, Knud (1994): Information structure and sentence form. Topic, focus, and the mental representations of discourse referents. Cambridge, New York, NY, USA: Cambridge University Press (Cambridge studies in linguistics).

Löbner, Sebastian (2013): Understanding semantics. Second Edition. New York: Routledge (Understanding language series).

Millikan, Ruth Garrett (Hg.) (2005): Language: A biological model. Oxford: Oxford University Press.

Murphy, M. Lynne (2010): Lexical Meaning. Cambridge: Cambridge University Press.

Parker, Frank; Riley, Kathryn (2009): Linguistics for Non-Linguists: A Primer with Exercises. 5th. London: Pearson.

Pechmann, Thomas (1989): Incremental speech production and referential overspecification. In: *Linguistics* 27 (1), S. 89–110.

Pragglejaz Group (2007): MIP: A Method for Identifying Metaphorically Used Words in Discourse. In: *Metaphor and Symbol* 22 (1), S. 1.

Riemer, Nick (2010): Introducing semantics. Cambridge, New York: Cambridge University Press (Cambridge introductions to language and linguistics).

Slobin, Dan I. (1991): Learning to think for speaking: Native language, cognition, and rhetorical style. In: *Pragmatics* 1 (1), S. 7–25.

Trueswell, John C.; Tanenhaus, Michael K.; Garnsey, Susan M. (1994): Semantic Influences on Parsing: Use of Thematic Role Information in Syntactic Ambiguity Resolution. In: *Journal of Memory and Language* 33 (3), S. 285–318.